

Shibuya, Japan's most popular shopping district, in a game run by beings called Reapers.

The game lasts for over a week and the grand prize is that he will get his life back. However he must partner with someone in order to survive. For Neku, the loner, his quest for life forces him to choose from one of three partners: the fashionista Shiki, the clever Joshua and the tough Beat.

The gameplay is quite intense, as each character takes up one of the dual screens. You control both you and your partner, using all of the DS functions. Yes, you yell into the DS mike, slash on the touchscreen, drawing shapes and lines to summon giant icicles, and use the command buttons furiously to win.

The enemies take on the form of small tattoo-like creatures that emerge from the "noise". To get powers you have to equip pins that resemble the funky, circular ones you put on bags. Each pin grants you powers, and each district within Shubiyia is governed by fashion. If your brand is the hottest in that particular area, then you get extra damage and drops bonuses. Fashion as a strategy element? These Japanese are crazy!

While the game might play out like an action game, it feels more like a role-playing game (RPG). The more you battle, the more experience points you gain. And you can pump up the difficulty on the fly to net some rare pins and extra XP. Collecting all the pins is fun and rewarding, especially when this gets your character fully powered up and racking up some insane combos.

The World Ends With You delivers some excellent graphics, pushing the DS to its maximum abilities. The Japanese Pop tunes are catchy and punchy.

In the end, the entire game feels like a project that the developers wanted to create for a long time, and what a fantastic world they have brought forth. The story is filled to the brim with delicious twists and turns, all the while powered by comic-like visuals.

This game is a must-have for anyone, even if you do not like RPG titles. Beware though, the fighting system has a steep learning curve; but once you master it, there is nothing on the DS which is as addictive. Here's hoping there's a sequel in the works...

Kirby Canvas Curse

Mario always ruled the roost in the Nintendo family, while Kirby was the ignored stepchild. Then again, maybe this was because Mario was a plumber, had a hot girlfriend and well, Kirby was a pink blob with hands and legs.

But it looks like Kirby has got his revenge with his latest title, *Canvas Curse*!

While the *New Super Mario Brothers* was excellent, *Kirby Canvas Curse* ups that tenfold, and slaps it around like yesterday's dessert. This is platforming at its very best.

As with most platformers, the story is pretty inconsequential. You probably will not even pay much attention to it, and all that you will remember is that